Mobile King Soopers Grocery Store

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Project overview

The product:

Enhance the in-store shopping experience by integrating real-time inventory updates, interactive store maps, and personalized recommendations.

Project duration:

Dec 2023 to Month Year

Preview of selected polished designs.

Project overview

The problem:

In-store shopping can be too crowded and displays and aisles change often. Customers are frustrated with time inefficiency. Additionally, there is a lack of real-time information on product availability and personalized promotions.

The goal:

The goal is to enhance in-store shopping experience by designing a user-friendly app and responsive website that provides real-time inventory updates and personalized recommendations. This aims to streamline the shopping process, save time for customers and fostering a more enjoyable experience

Project overview

My role:

Lead UX designer who will be designing the app and website

Responsibilities:

My responsibilities include conceptualizing, designing, and implementing the user experience across both digital platforms.

Understanding the user

- User research
- Personas
- Problem statements
- User journey maps

User research: summary

Design a King Sooper app and website that aims to enhance the convenience and efficiency of the in-store shopping experience for the diverse user base. By focusing on intuitive navigation, real-time updates, and personalized features, the goal is to create a seamless and enjoyable journey for users at every touchpoint.

User research: pain points

1

Inefficient Shopping Process

The current lack of a streamlined process results in shoppers spending more time than necessary in the store, affecting overall satisfaction.

2

Limited Information of Product Availability

Shoppers face issues with availability of specific products. This leads to disappointment and the need for staff assistance.

3

Inconsistency between Platforms

The lack of consistency between the app and website may cause confusion for users who switch between devices during their shopping journey.

4

Complicated Navigation

A confusing or non-intuitive navigation system in both the app and website can frustrate users, hindering their ability to find products and complete their shopping efficiently.

Persona: **Richard**

Problem statement:

Richard is a retiree who is not very tech savvy who needs a shopping app that is simple to use because he does not want to wander around the store looking for items that are not there but enjoy his shopping experience using the app.

Richard

Age: 65
Education: PhD
Hometown: Boston
Family: Married for 40 years
Occupation: Retired

"I hesitate using technology. Just want to keep things simple"

Goals

- Wants to navigate the store efficiently and locate items on his list without spending too much time searching.
- Despite being less tech-savvy, Richard appreciates digital tools that simplify his life.
- Being on a fixed income, he is keen on promotions and discounts to manage his budget.

Frustrations

- Finds overly complex apps challenging to use, and he values simplicity and ease of use.
- Motivated to save money and appreciates personalized discounts and promotions that align with his purchasing habits.

Richard, a 65-year-old retiree, decides to try the King Soopers app to enhance his shopping experience. He is familiar with technology, using a smartphone for essential tasks but does prefer straight forward experience since he can feel overwhelmed using technology.

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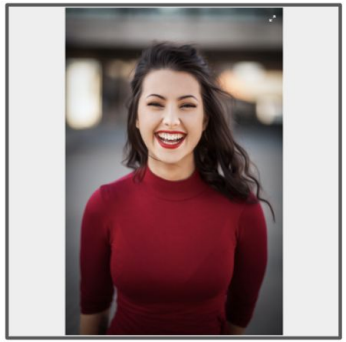
Persona: **Sarah**

Problem statement:

Sarah is a working professional who is always on the go who needs her shopping experience to be efficient and effective because she can't waste time looking for items or promotions.



Sarah

Age: 32
Education: MBA
Hometown: Los Angeles, CA
Family: 2 sisters
Occupation: Working Professional

"With my chaotic life, I want things to feel like a breeze and time savers are important to me."

Goals

- Find the items on her shopping list quickly
- Take advantage of personalized promotions and discounts
- Navigate the store efficiently to save time.

Frustrations

- Wandering through the store searching for items.
- If using the current app, she misses out on promotions and discounts.

A 32 year old working professional who frequently shops at King Soopers. She wants an app so she can quickly add items from her shopping list to save time and avoid the long crowded aisles.

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User journey map

Goals:

Enhance User Engagement: The UX designer aims to improve user engagement at each touchpoint in the journey. This involves creating an experience that is not only functional but also enjoyable for the users.
Streamline Navigation and Interactions: Prioritize improvements in the navigation flow and interactive elements. The goal is to make it intuitive for users to move through the app and website seamlessly.
Optimize Personalization: Understand the importance of personalized experiences for users like Sarah and Richard. The designer wants to refine algorithms to provide more accurate suggestions and personalized notifications.
Prioritize Accessibility: Ensure that the app and website cater to users of all abilities, especially considering that Richard is an older user. The designer wants to focus on making the interface easily accessible and user-friendly.
Iterative Improvement: Embrace a mindset of continuous improvement. The designer aims to use feedback from users like Sarah and Richard to iteratively enhance the app and website, ensuring it evolves with user needs.

Thought Process:

User-Centric Design: The designer places the user at the center of the design process. Understanding Sarah and Richard's needs, preferences, and pain points is paramount to making informed design decisions.
Data-Driven Decision Making: Rely on data from user interactions and feedback to drive design decisions. Regularly analyze user behavior to identify areas of improvement and validate design choices.
Simplicity and Clarity: Prioritize simplicity in design to create a straightforward and clear user experience. The thought process involves evaluating each design element to ensure it adds value without unnecessary complexity.
Cross-Platform Consistency: Ensure consistency between the app and website designs. The designer thinks about the user experience across different platforms, aiming for a cohesive and familiar interaction regardless of the device.
Empathy and Inclusivity: Infuse empathy into the design process, considering the diverse needs and abilities of users. The thought process involves anticipating potential challenges faced by users like Richard and addressing them proactively.
Feedback Integration: Actively seek and integrate user feedback. The designer values user input as a crucial component for refining the design, addressing pain points, and enhancing overall satisfaction.
Collaborative Approach: Engage in collaboration with other team members, including developers and stakeholders. The thought process involves fostering open communication to ensure alignment between design goals and technical feasibility.
Future-Forward Design: Anticipate future user needs and technological advancements. The designer aims to create a design framework that is flexible and adaptive to evolving user expectations and industry trends.

Persona: Sarah

Goal: Enhance in-store shopping experience for customers by designing and user-friendly app and website to help them locate products efficiently.

ACTION	Planning Shopping	In-Store Navigation	Finding Products	Checkout Experience	Post-Shopping Review	Overall Satisfaction
TASK LIST	Use the app's smart suggestions to add essential items to the shopping list. Manually add specific items not suggested by the app. Set preferences for notifications on personalized discounts and promotions.	Follow the app's real-time guided route to navigate through the store. Receive timely notifications about promotions and discounts while in-store. Utilize the interactive store map to locate specific aisles efficiently.	Use the search feature to locate items on the shopping list quickly. Explore the interactive store map to find items based on their location. Receive real-time updates on product availability and alternative suggestions.	Apply personalized discounts and promotions during the checkout process. Receive real-time feedback on applied discounts and overall savings. Rate and provide feedback on the checkout experience and the app as a whole.	Review the post-shopping summary detailing savings and items purchased. Save the shopping list for future reference or modifications. Receive personalized recommendations based on the latest shopping trip.	Reflect on the overall shopping experience and provide feedback.
FEELING ADJECTIVE	Excited	Confident	Satisfied	Content	Gratified	Satisfied
IMPROVEMENT OPPORTUNITIES	Enhance the algorithm for more accurate and personalized suggestions. Provide a user-friendly manual input interface for additional items. Improve the visibility and customization options for notifications.	Ensure seamless real-time updates to enhance the accuracy of navigation. Optimize notification delivery to align with the user's shopping journey. Enhance the map with clearer visuals and additional wayfinding cues	Implement predictive text and visual cues for a user-friendly search. Add visual indicators for personalized recommendations on the map. Ensure accuracy in inventory updates for a seamless shopping experience.	Simplify the checkout interface for an efficient and user-friendly process. Provide clear and instant feedback to enhance the user's confidence. Encourage users to share their thoughts to improve the overall system.	Enhance the summary for a quick and comprehensive review experience. Implement features for easy sharing and exporting of shopping lists. Continuously refine recommendations to align with user preferences.	Conduct periodic surveys to gather insights and refine the user experience.

Persona: Richard

Goal: Enhance in-store shopping experience for customers by designing and user-friendly app and website to help them locate products efficiently.

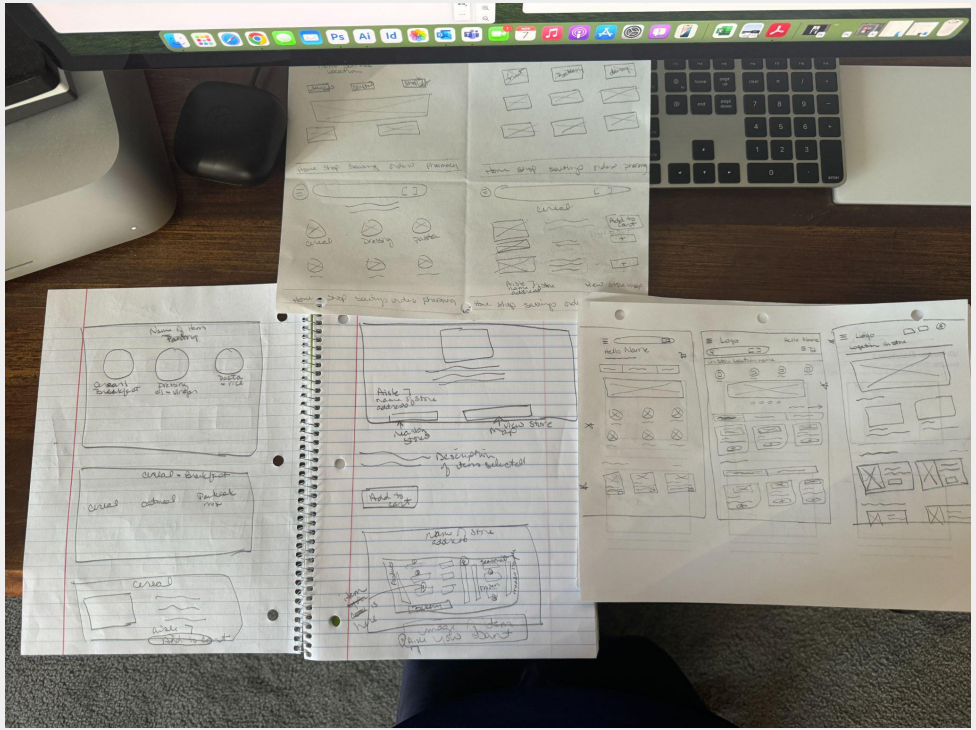
ACTION	Manual List Creation	Navigating with App	Efficient Item Search	Hassle-Free Checkout	Post-Shopping Review	Overall Satisfaction
TASK LIST	Add items manually to the shopping list. Utilize app features for basic navigation and item suggestions. Adjust preferences for a personalized shopping experience.	Follow the app's guided route through the store. Receive notifications about promotions and discounts while navigating. Utilize the interactive store map to locate specific aisles efficiently.	Use the app's search feature to quickly locate manually added items. Explore the interactive store map to find items based on their location. Receive real-time updates on product availability and alternative suggestions.	Apply personalized discounts seamlessly during checkout. Receive real-time feedback on applied discounts and overall savings. Rate and provide feedback on the checkout experience and the app as a whole.	Review the post-shopping summary detailing savings and items purchased. Save the shopping list for future reference or modifications. Receive personalized recommendations based on the latest shopping trip.	Reflect on the overall shopping experience and provide feedback.
FEELING ADJECTIVE	Cautious	Reassured	Pleased	Relieved	Content	Appreciative
IMPROVEMENT OPPORTUNITIES	Provide a step-by-step guide for manual input to boost confidence. Offer tutorial pop-ups for key features to enhance user familiarity. Ensure settings customization is straightforward and user-friendly.	Improve the clarity of navigation prompts for a smoother experience. Optimize notification delivery to align with the user's shopping journey. Enhance the map with clearer visuals and additional wayfinding cues.	Implement predictive text and visual cues for a user-friendly search. Add visual indicators for personalized recommendations on the map. Ensure accuracy in inventory updates for a seamless shopping experience.	Simplify the checkout interface for a stress-free experience. Provide clear and instant feedback to enhance the user's confidence. Encourage users to share their thoughts to improve the overall system.	Ensure the summary is clear and highlights savings for better understanding. Implement features for easy retrieval of saved lists for convenience. Continuously refine recommendations to align with user preferences.	Conduct periodic usability sessions with older users for continuous improvement.

Starting the design

- Paper wireframes
- Digital wireframes
- Low-fidelity prototype
- Usability studies

Paper wireframes

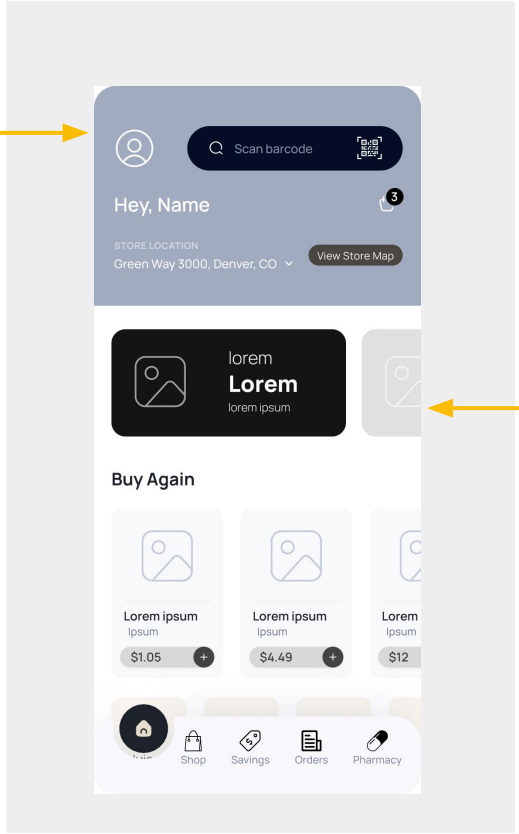
The goal of the King Soopers app and website is to streamline and enhance the in-store shopping experience by offering intuitive category organization, quick item location, and a simplified self-checkout process. Key features include an accessible category menu with aisle locations, an interactive map for easy navigation, and a quick-add option for adding items to a cart or shopping list with a single tap. The app also enables customers to scan items as they shop, reducing checkout lines and providing a faster, more efficient experience. Designed with usability and accessibility in mind, the app ensures clear navigation for all users, with high-contrast text, prominent icons, and an optional tutorial for guidance. This approach prioritizes a convenient, user-centered experience, making grocery shopping seamless and efficient.



Digital wireframes

Even after my paper wireframes I still keep changing the designs. I find with paper, it gets my creative juices going but in digital I see clearly and am able to figure for a simple and clean look that I'm trying to go for.

All of the important information goes to the top. Profile, which store they are in, view the map, cart, etc.



Originally I was going to use a carousel but I think i prefer making them individual sliders.

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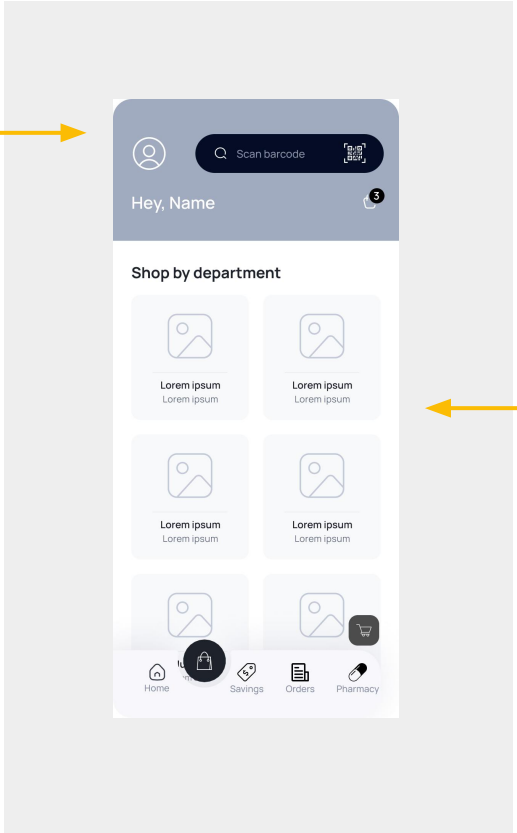
Digital wireframes

Have an easy process when looking for product

Stays consistent with a few minor changes.



Easy to see category

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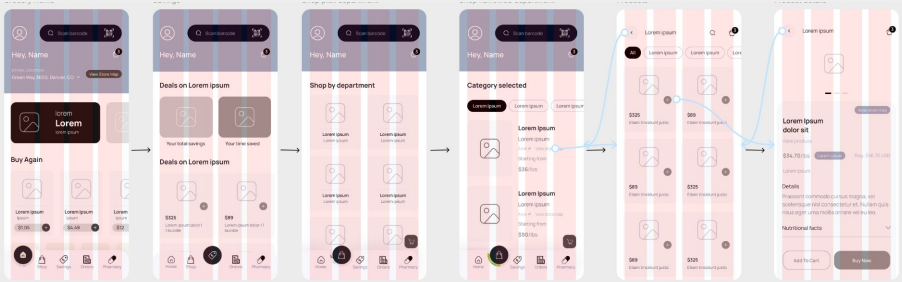
Low-fidelity prototype

The process is the user will land on the homescreen and decide what tab they are looking for. Once a category is selected they have more options and also have an opportunity to see where the item is located. To help eliminate time standing in line they can scan their product as they go.



Usability study: findings

Two rounds of usability studies were conducted to gather valuable insights and feedback on the King Soopers grocery store app and website. The first study, using wireframes, helped guide the design towards creating detailed mockups. The second study, using a high-fidelity prototype, provided insight into which aspects of the mockups required further refinement. The results of these studies helped to ensure that the King Soopers app is user-friendly, efficient, and meets the needs of in-store shoppers.

Round 1 findings

1. Users experienced difficulty with navigation between product search and store map.
2. Real-time feedback on applied discounts during checkout is essential for a satisfying experience.
3. Older users preferred larger text and higher contrast for readability, highlighting accessibility needs.

Round 2 findings

1. Importance of a clear and visually appealing store map for easy product location and guidance.
2. Positive perception of personalized discounts, with a preference for ongoing visibility throughout the shopping journey.
3. Users appreciated streamlined navigation improvements, but a quick tutorial was requested for first-time users to understand main features.

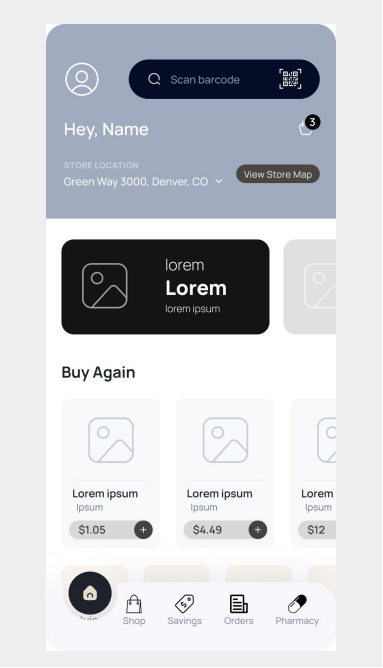
Refining the design

- Mockups
- High-fidelity prototype
- Accessibility

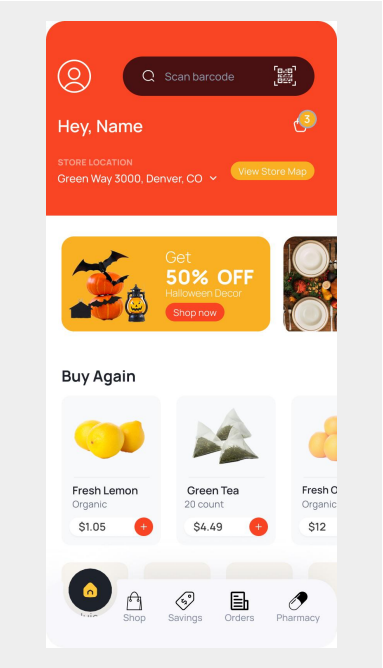
Mockups

I feel like the first home page I had slight changes. For instance I had a menu bar and realized I needed a profile, so I quickly made the change in the wireframe. There wasn't a point in having a menu if I already have the tabs at the bottom.

Before usability study



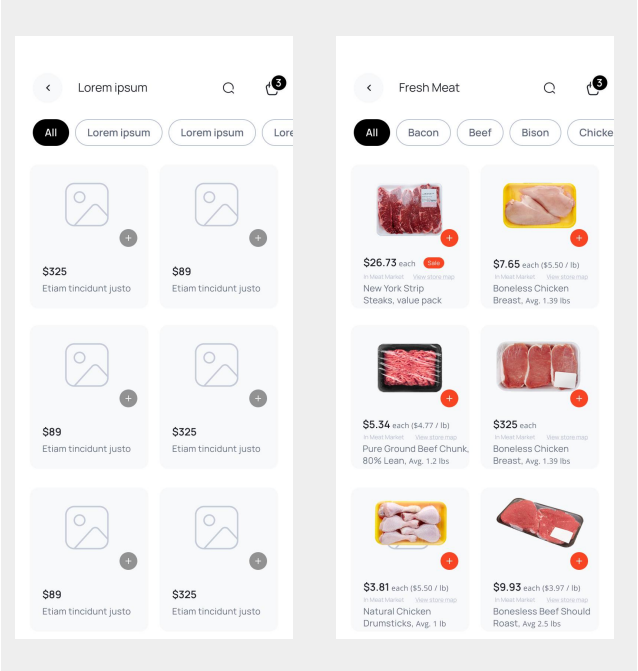
After usability study



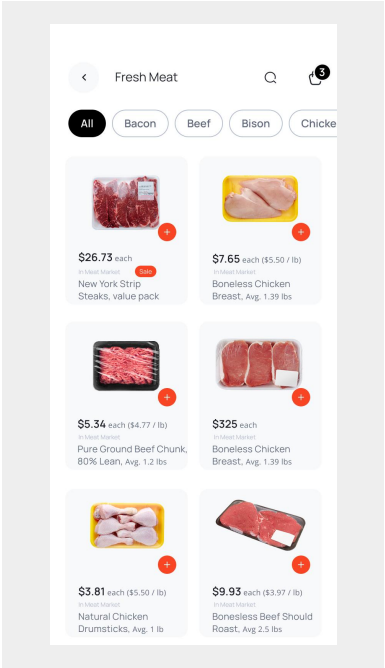
Mockups

For this wireframe I didn't see it until after I started on the hi-fi. If you look closely I originally added a 'view store map' for each item. With me already adding the aisle number and having too much information there already, I decided to remove the link and instead add it to the individual product item page.

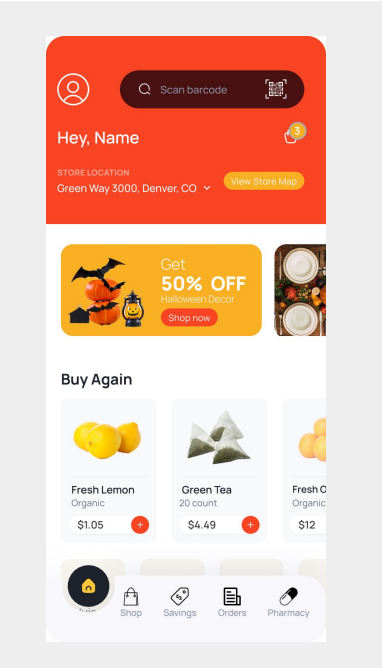
Before usability study

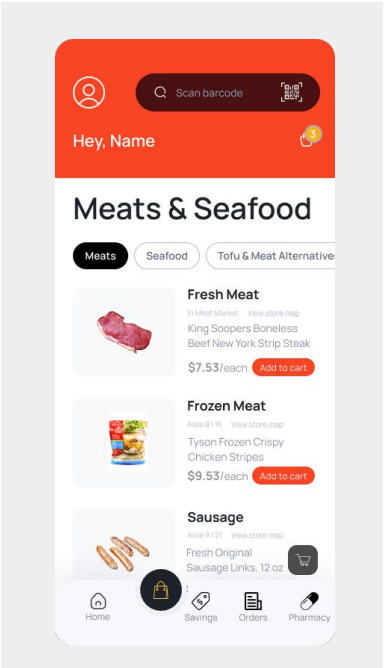


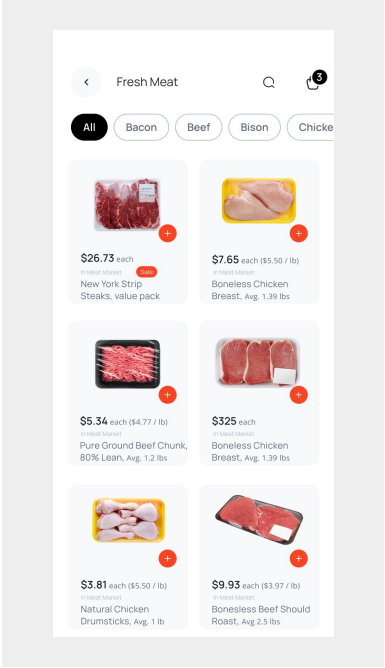
After usability study

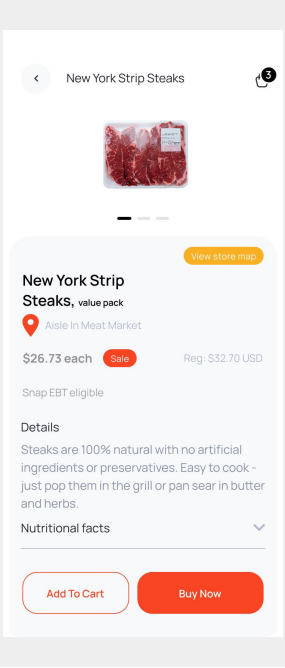


Mockups









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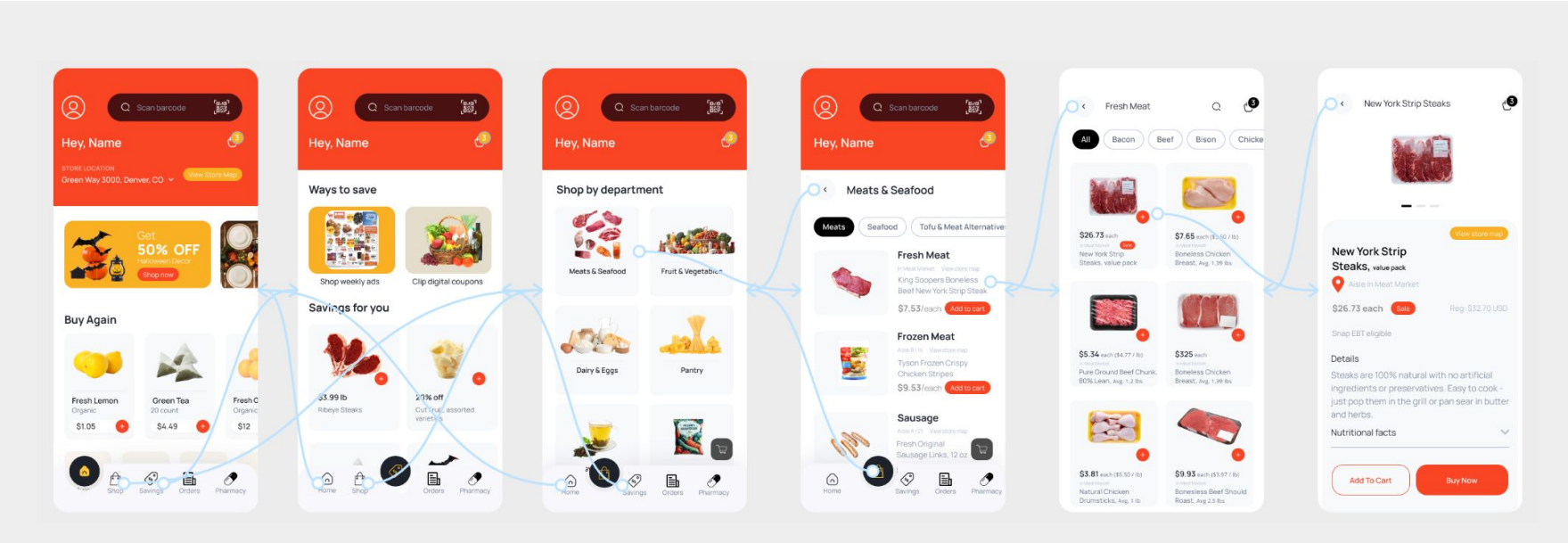
High-fidelity prototype

[Link to my prototype]



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Accessibility considerations

1

I used a vision simulator to ensure that the color contrast in my designs meets accessibility standards, making the interface usable for individuals with color blindness. Additionally, I prioritized clear visual hierarchy and text legibility to accommodate a wide range of users.

2

I ensured the design is compatible with screen readers, allowing users to access the app's content and functionality through audio. This ensures accessibility for individuals who rely on auditory assistance for navigation.

3

All images in the design are high resolution, allowing users to zoom in without losing clarity. This ensures that individuals with low vision can view and interpret content more effectively.

Going forward

- Takeaways
- Next steps

Takeaways

Impact:

The design of the King Soopers app and website has the potential to significantly enhance the user experience by improving accessibility, navigation, and overall usability. By incorporating user feedback, addressing accessibility considerations, and refining key features, the design ensures a more seamless and efficient shopping experience. One study participant noted that the layout felt “intuitive and easy to navigate,” making it simpler to find products and complete purchases. These improvements demonstrate how thoughtful design choices can create a more user-friendly and inclusive digital experience.

What I learned:

Throughout this project, I learned that even small design changes can have a significant impact on the overall user experience. User testing and feedback played a crucial role in shaping the final design, reinforcing the importance of iteration in the design process. The most valuable takeaway for me is the need to always prioritize the real needs of users when developing design ideas and solutions. By focusing on usability, accessibility, and user pain points, I was able to refine the app into a more intuitive and effective product.

Next steps

1

Figure out if there are any other areas that need to be worked on.

2

Continue cleaning out project and making sure it’s ready for the client.

3

Always double check and triple check the functionality of the project

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Let’s connect!

Thank you for reviewing my work with King Soopers app.

If you would like to see more, or would like to get in touch, my contact information is provided below:

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